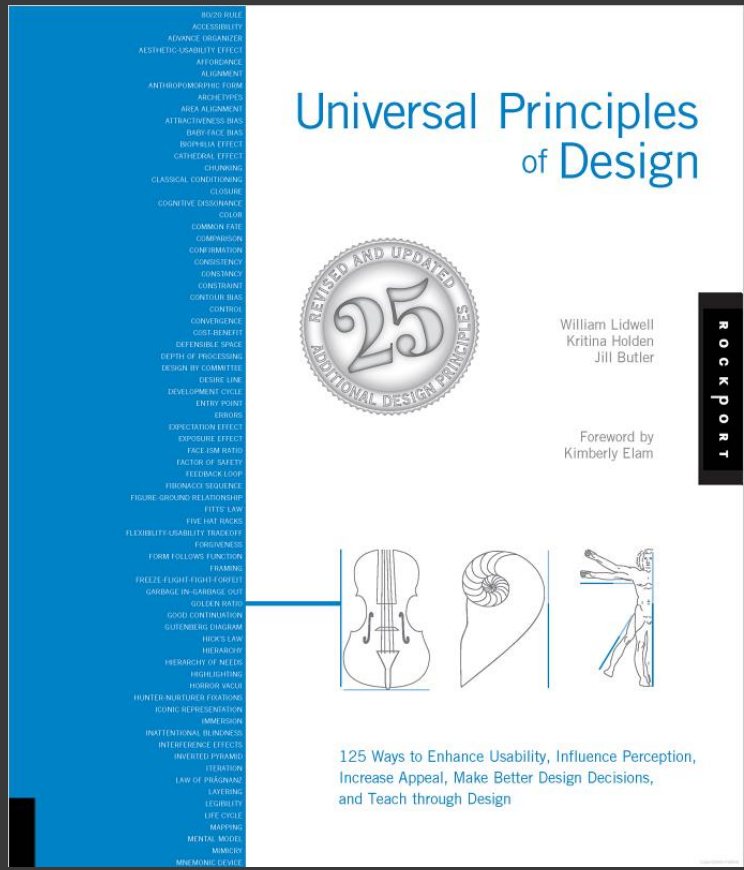
THE HARMONY OF DESIGN
FUNDAMENTAL ELEMENTS OF DESIGN

Michael Smith
mike@slideheroes.com

SLIDEHEROES

OUT OF SCOPE

- Point
- Shape & Form
- Direction
- Size
- Texture
- Rhythm



Lidwell, Holden, Butler

GOLDEN RULE

OUR DESIGN GOAL IS HARMONY AND SIMPLICITY

Simplicity is not an aesthetic preference, rather, it is a tool. We are aiming to communicate our message as efficiently as possible – simplicity services this goal

REPETITION 2

ALIGNMENT 3

PROXIMITY 4

TYPOGRAPHY 5

COLOR 6

WHITESPACE 7

LESSON SUMMARY

ALIGN OBSESSIVELY
Every element on the slide must be properly aligned

MATCH COLORS
Use two or three conservative, complimentary colors

USE WHITESPACE
Ensure adequate whitespace – leave stuff out to create negative space

CONTRAST
Use contrast to emphasize your main message

REPEAT ELEMENTS
Repeat key slide design elements across every slide

CREATE HIERARCHY
Create a visual hierarchy by grouping visual elements together

USE TYPOGRAPHY
Use custom fonts

LESSON SUMMARY

ALIGN OBSESSIVELY
Every element on the slide must be properly aligned

MATCH COLORS
Use two or three conservative, complimentary colors

USE WHITESPACE
Ensure adequate whitespace – leave stuff out to create negative space

CONTRAST
Use contrast to emphasize your main message

REPEAT ELEMENTS
Repeat key slide design elements across every slide

CREATE HIERARCHY
Create a visual hierarchy by grouping visual elements together

USE TYPOGRAPHY
Use custom fonts

CONTRAST

CONTRAST

1

Contrast occurs when two elements on a page are different. If two items are not exactly the same, then make them different. VERY different.

carsonified
creativity with integrity

Home

FUTURE INSIGHTS COMMUNITY

WE LOVE THE WEB

Training, inspiring and connecting Web Designers and Developers is our passion.

ONLINE VIDEO TUTORIALS FOR WEB DESIGNERS & DEVELOPERS

TREEHOUSE

WORLD CLASS CONFERENCES FOR DESIGNERS AND DEVELOPERS

FUTURE OF WEB APPS

FUTURE OF WEB DESIGN

FUTURE OF MOBILE

REPETITION

REPETITION

REPETITION

2

The principle of repetition simply means the reusing of the same or similar elements throughout your design

HEADLINE PLACEHOLDER
Footnote: Very important source of critical data and insight.
1 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com
HEADLINE PLACEHOLDER
Footnote: Very important source of critical data and insight.
2 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com
Repeatable Elements
STANDARD SECTION SLIDES
3 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com
HEADLINE PLACEHOLDER
Footnote: Very important source of critical data and insight.
4 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com
HEADLINE PLACEHOLDER
Footnote: Very important source of critical data and insight.
5 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com
HEADLINE PLACEHOLDER
Footnote: Very important source of critical data and insight.
6 Michael Smith | www.slideheroes.com

REPETITION IN SLIDE DECKS

1. Standard graph layouts
2. Standard section slides
3. Standard footnote locations
4. Signposts for the section

ALIGNMENT

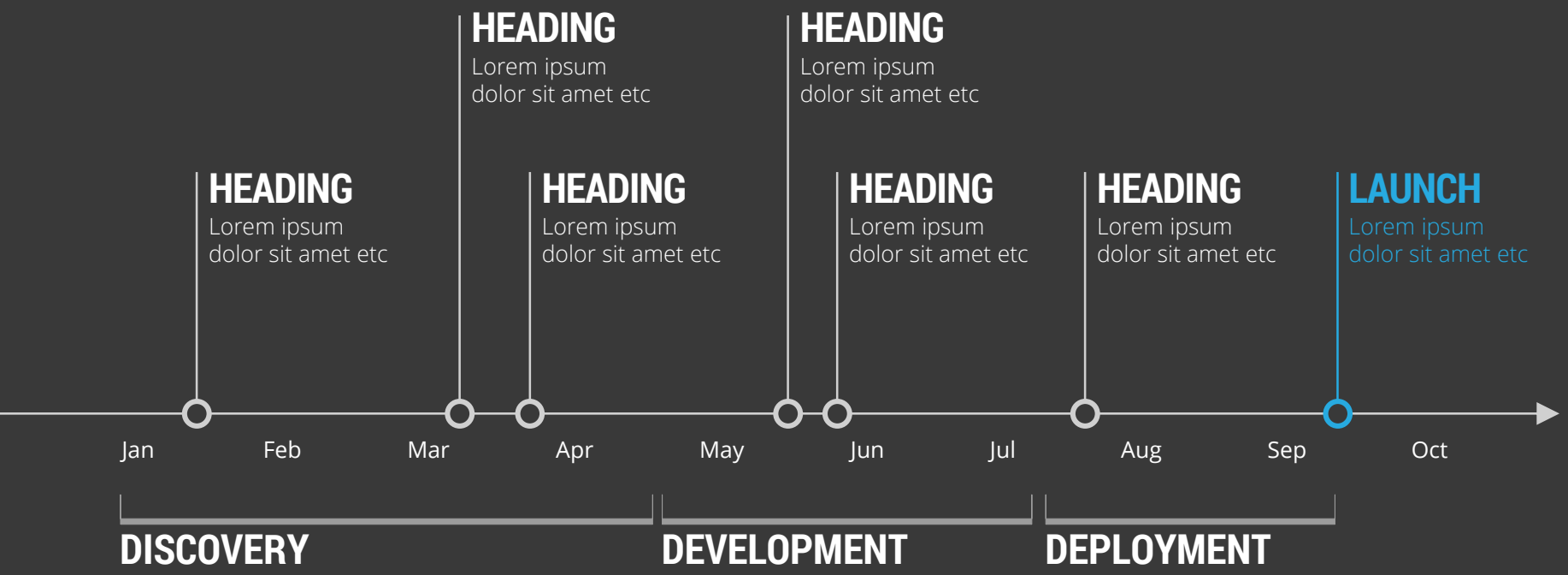
3

The principle of alignment is about ensuring nothing is placed on the page arbitrarily. Every item visually connects with something else.

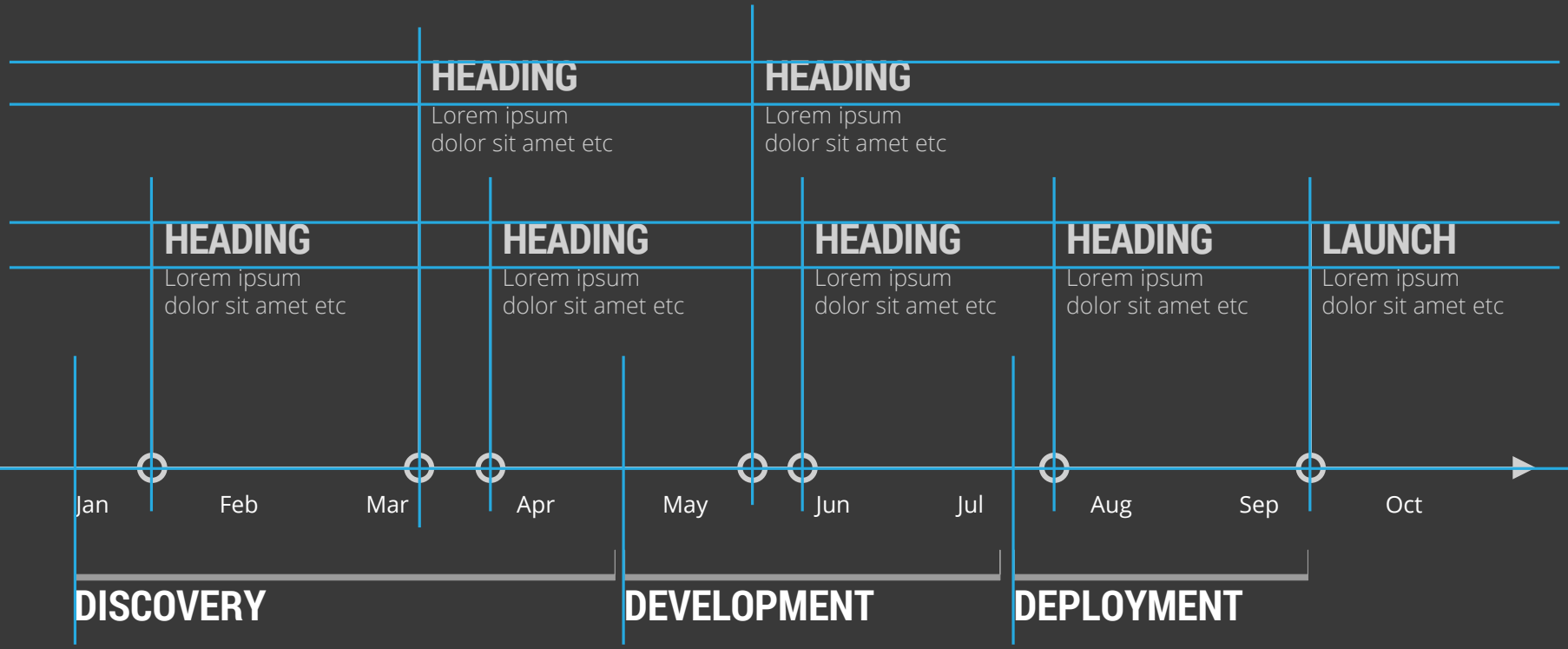
COMMON ROWS, COLUMNS OR CENTER

COMMON ROWS, COLUMNS OR CENTER

ALL ELEMENTS ALIGN WITH OTHER ELEMENTS



ALL ELEMENTS ALIGN WITH OTHER ELEMENTS



PROXIMITY

4

The principle of proximity is about moving things closer or farther apart to achieve a more organized look.

COMMON ROWS, COLUMNS OR CENTER

COMMON ROWS, COLUMNS OR CENTER

TYPOGRAPHY 5

Typography is the art and technique of arranging type in order to make language visible

CUSTOM FONTS

1 Try Google fonts

CUSTOM FONTS

1. Try Google fonts
2. Use custom fonts
   - When org is tech savvy
   - When you share via pdf

CUSTOM FONTS

1. Try Google fonts
2. Use custom fonts
   - When org is tech savvy
   - When you share via pdf

CUSTOM FONTS

1. Try Google fonts
2. Use custom fonts
   - When org is tech savvy
   - When you share via pdf
3. Use font combinations

TYPOGRAPHY THAT WORKS

DOSIS EXAMPLE

Open Sans – example text

LATO EXAMPLE

Grand – example

FJALLA – EXAMPLE

Cantarell – example

OSWALD EXAMPLE

Droid Sans – example

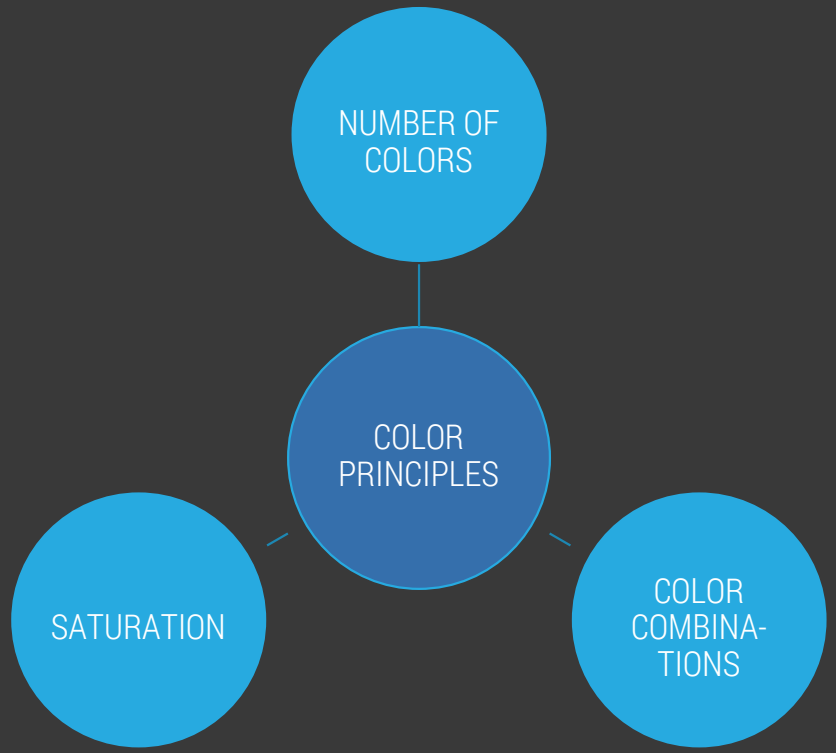
Google Fonts

COLOR

6

Color is used in design to attract attention, group elements, indicate meaning, and enhance aesthetics

COLOR PRINCIPLES

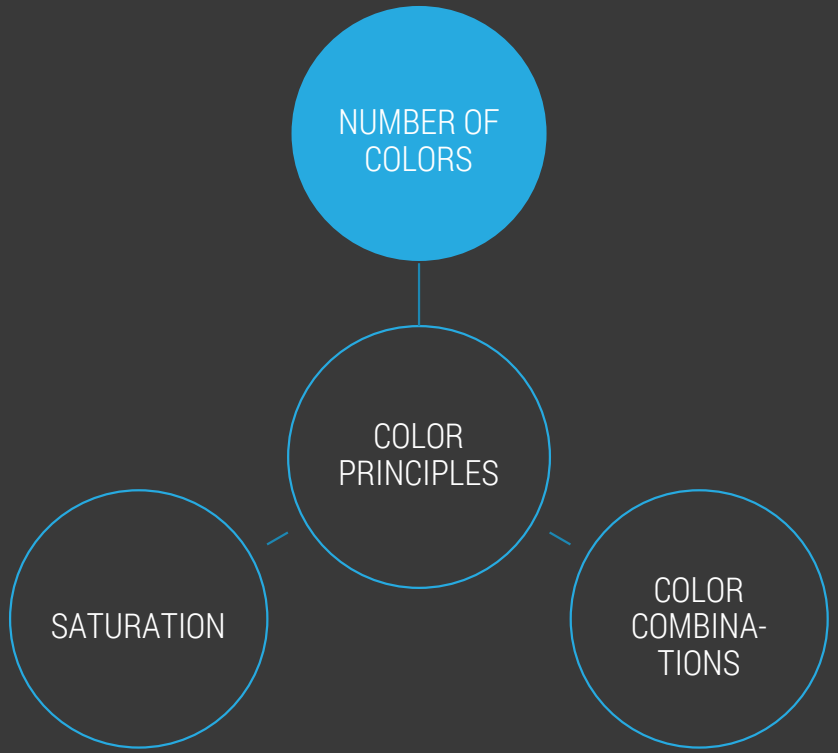


USE COLOR THOUGHTFULLY

Color is used in design to attract attention, group elements, indicate meaning, and enhance aesthetics.

Color can enhance a presentation but, if used improperly, color can also seriously harm the design

COLOR PRINCIPLES



USE COLOR THOUGHTFULLY

Color is used in design to attract attention, group elements, indicate meaning, and enhance aesthetics.

Color can enhance a presentation but, if used improperly, color can also seriously harm the design

IDEATRANSPLANT

PITCHING IDEAS WITH GOOD PRESENTATION DESIGN

Portfolio | About | Contact | RSS feed | Facebook | Twitter | Google+ | Vimeo | Get the book

Too much color

Colours brighten up your slides and are a great way to group related items together: USA is green, Europe is blue, Asia is purple for example.

But applying bold colours to big text boxes makes your slides too busy and nervous. Instead, keep those text boxes light grey and add a very narrow colour box attached to it at the left side, almost like a fat line.

+3 Recommend this on Google

12/05/2013 3 Comments

3 Comments Community Login

Sort by Best Share Favorite

Join the discussion...

David Faibish · 3 months ago
Your favorite typo in line 6 - "to" instead of "too". Take care and thnks for these great " mini-posts".
Reply · Share

Jan Schultink Mod → David Faibish · 3 months ago
Thank you
Reply · Share

Rob Hooft · 4 months ago
The marketing director for the company I used to work for had a great German phrase for this when we were discussing user interfaces: "farbig, aber nicht bunt". This could probably be translated as "colored, but not colorful". Does not have the same feel to it, though....
Reply · Share

Follow @ideatransplant | 3,406 followers

ABOUT IDEATRANSPLANT

Presentation design firm Idea Transplant creates conference, sales, and investor presentations.

Jan Schultink is a presentation designer with a decade of experience as a CEO strategy consultant with McKinsey & Company.

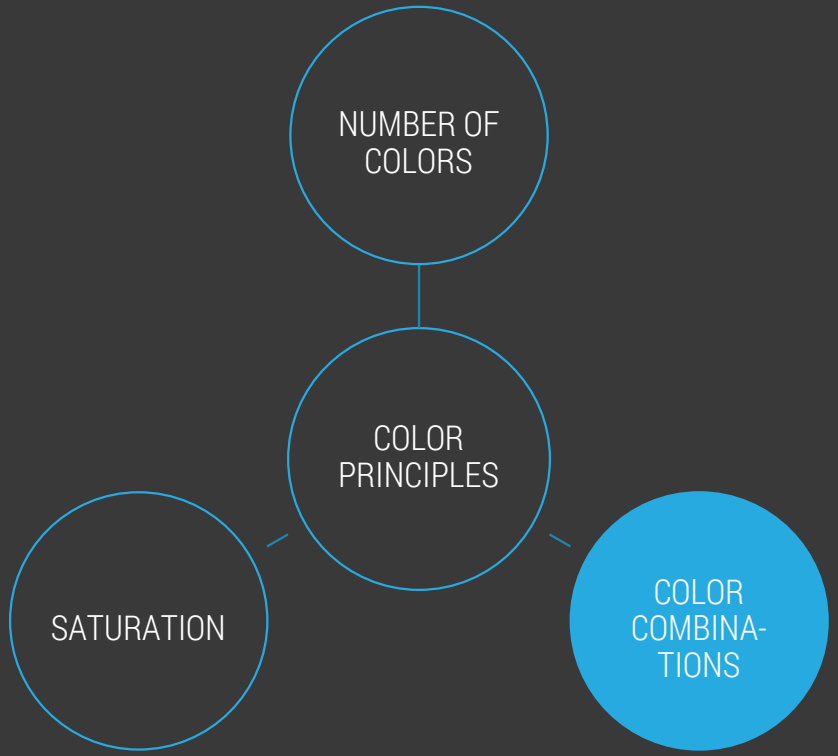
Besides his design work at Idea Transplant, Jan is CEO of Pitchera, an exciting new web-based presentation app that has set itself the ambition of becoming a "PowerPoint killer". You can register your interest here at **Pitchera.com**.

BLOG UPDATES VIA EMAIL

me@email.com Subscribe

MY BOOK ABOUT PRESENTATION DESIGN

COLOR PRINCIPLES



USE COLOR THOUGHTFULLY

Color is used in design to attract attention, group elements, indicate meaning, and enhance aesthetics.

Color can enhance a presentation but, if used improperly, color can also seriously harm the design

COLOR COMBINATIONS

1. Adjacent / analogous
2. Opposing / complementary
3. Corners of triangle / triadic & quadratic
4. From nature

COLOR COMBINATIONS

1. Adjacent / analogous
2. Opposing / complementary
3. Corners of triangle / triadic & quadratic
4. From nature

COLOR COMBINATIONS

1. Adjacent / analogous
2. Opposing / complementary
3. Corners of triangle / triadic & quadratic
4. From nature

COLOR COMBINATIONS

1. Adjacent / analogous
2. Opposing / complementary
3. Corners of triangle / triadic & quadratic
4. From nature

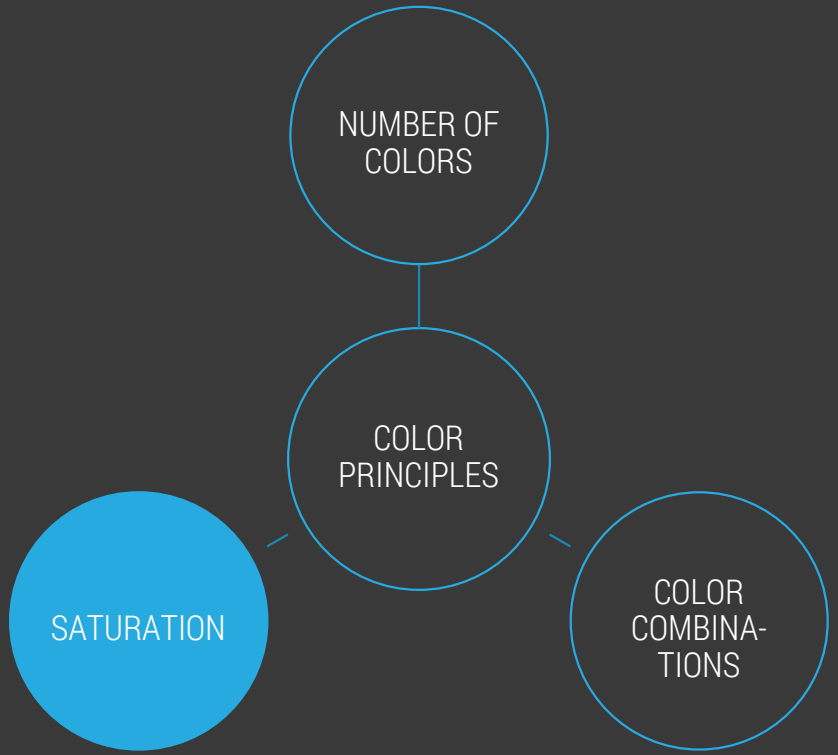
uler Create Explore My Themes

Save My Kuler Theme

Color Rule

- Analogous
- Monochromatic
- Triad
- Complementary
- Compound
- Shades
- Custom

COLOR PRINCIPLES



USE COLOR THOUGHTFULLY

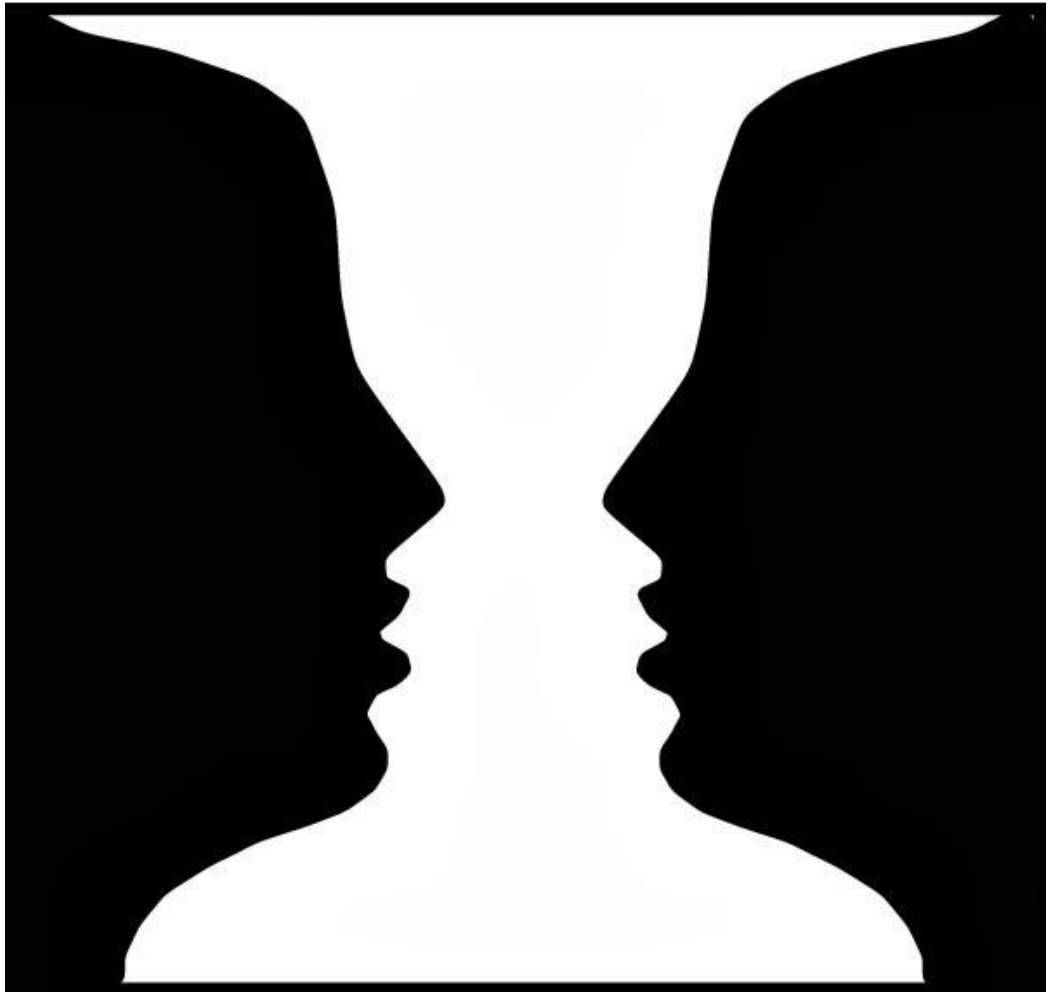
Color is used in design to attract attention, group elements, indicate meaning, and enhance aesthetics.

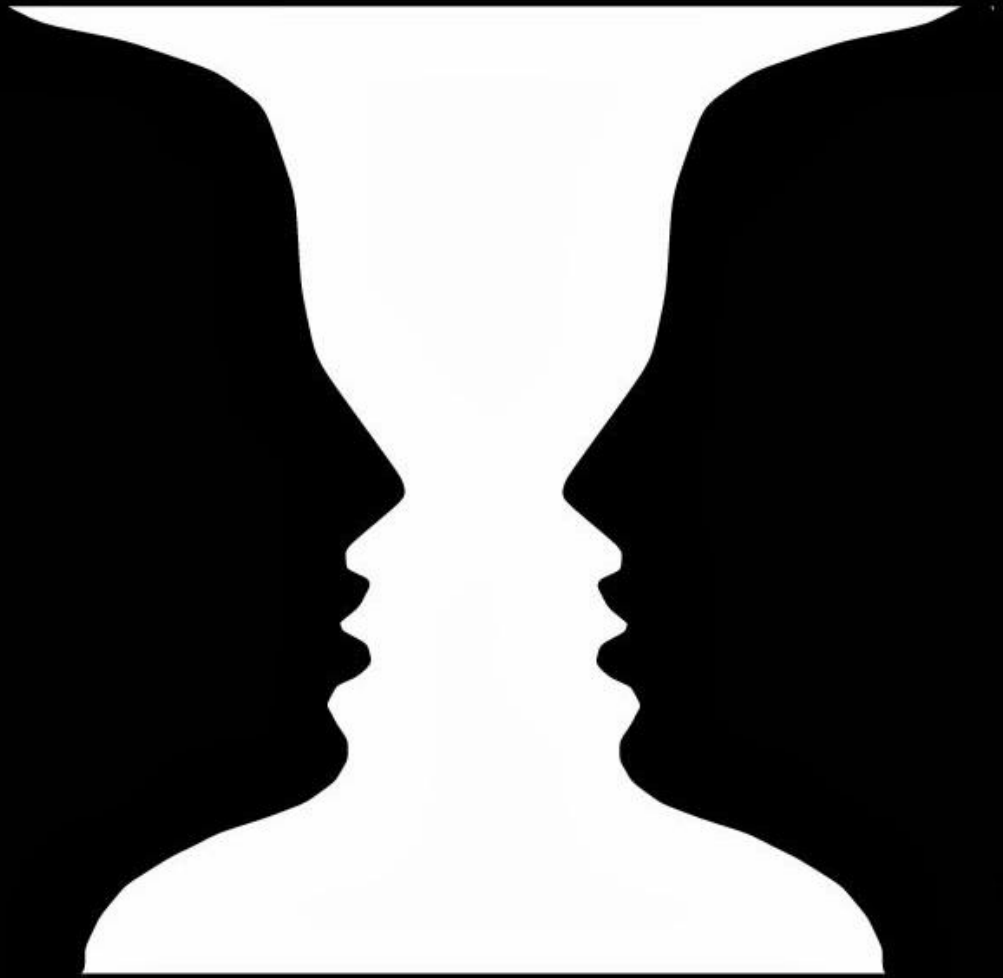
Color can enhance a presentation but, if used improperly, color can also seriously harm the design

WHITESPACE

7

Whitespace, or negative space, is the portion of a page left unmarked: margins, gutters, and space between columns, lines of type, graphics, or figures.





WHITESPACE BENEFITS

1. Improved legibility
2. Higher comprehension
3. Increased attention
4. Creates the right tone

TEXT LINE SPACING RULES OF THUMB

- The equivalent of ¼ of a line between lines. Achieve this be utilizing the ‘Exactly’ setting in the paragraph formatting settings

TEXT LINE SPACING RULES OF THUMB

- The equivalent of ¼ of a line between lines. Achieve this be utilizing the 'Exactly' setting in the paragraph formatting settings

- The equivalent of 1 line between paragraphs

TEXT LINE SPACING RULES OF THUMB

- The equivalent of ¼ of a line between lines. Achieve this be utilizing the 'Exactly' setting in the paragraph formatting settings
- The equivalent of 1 line between paragraphs
- Limit the number of words to under 30

Google purchases Skybox Imaging satellite firm for $500m

Google said late on Tuesday it agreed to buy satellite start-up firm Skybox Imaging for $500 million in cash.

Google said Skybox’s satellites will help keep Google Maps accurate with up-to-date imagery.

In time, Google said it hopes that Skybox’s team and technology will also be able to help improve internet access and disaster relief — areas that Google said it has long been interested in.

Skybox said on its website that it builds satellites, writes code, and deploys data centres.

In its statement, Skybox said the time was right “to join a company who can challenge us to think even bigger and bolder, and who can support us in accelerating our ambitious vision.”

Skybox said it had built and launched the world’s smallest high¬-resolution imaging satellite, which collects images and video every day.

“We have built an incredible team and empowered them to push the state-of-the-art in imaging to new heights,” said Skybox.

Google purchases Skybox Imaging satellite firm for $500m

Google said late on Tuesday it agreed to buy satellite start-up firm Skybox Imaging for $500 million in cash.

Google said Skybox's satellites will help keep Google Maps accurate with up-to-date imagery.

In time, Google said it hopes that Skybox's team and technology will also be able to help improve internet access and disaster relief — areas that Google said it has long been interested in.

Skybox said on its website that it builds satellites, writes code, and deploys data centres.

In its statement, Skybox said the time was right "to join a company who can challenge us to think even bigger and bolder, and who can support us in accelerating our ambitious vision."

Skybox said it had built and launched the world's smallest high¬-resolution imaging satellite, which collects images and video every day.

"We have built an incredible team and empowered them to push the state-of-the-art in imaging to new heights," said Skybox.